Scope

It is important to narrow down your research topic and limit the scope of your study. The researcher should inform the reader about limits or coverage of the study. The scope identifies the boundaries of the study in term of subjects, objectives, facilities, area, time frame, and the issues to which the research is focused.

Sample phrases that help express the scope of the study:

The coverage of this study…….

The study consists of …….

The study covers the …….

This study is focus on…….

Significance of the study (justification)

Highlights the reasons for conducting the research like what gaps in knowledge would the study address? Will it contribute to the solution of an immediate problem? Who will the research benefit?

Limitations and Delimitations

In this section, you are expected to state the desirable conditions which were not met and which are expected to influence the external and /or internal validity of the research study. It may be possible, for instance that an experimental study is inevitably. Limitation are those conditions beyond the control of the researcher that may place restrictions on the conclusions of the study and their applications to other situations. These may include the use of invalidated instrument, inability to randomly solid and assign subjects to experimental and control groups, some administrative policies etc.

Delimitations give you the boundaries of the study. The conclusions are not to be extended beyond these boundaries. It tells you about the target population, what the research intends to do and what he intends not to do. When stating the delimitations, you are required to rule out all variables and issues considered irrelevant to the research. It is not the same thing as limitations.